The examination is being carried out on the **following application documents**

Description, Pages

1-17 as originally filed

Claims, Numbers

1-14 as originally filed

Drawings, Sheets

1/23-23/23 as originally filed

1 Reference is made to the following document; the numbering will be adhered to in the rest of the procedure:

D1: US 2020/159220 A1

2 Document D1, which is considered to represent the most relevant state of the art, discloses:

A mobile device (180, see par. [0045]) comprising:
a processor (obvious feature in this context);
memory (obvious feature within *a tablet or other computing device*), coupled to the processor (obvious feature within *a tablet or other computing device*), the memory containing instructions that when executed cause the processor to provide an autonomy management application, wherein the autonomy management application includes an autonomy approval function;
the autonomy approval function providing a user interface configured to display at least one aspect of an autonomy job to a user and receive user acceptance of the autonomy job (see par. [0044]-[0049]).

3 Although the claims appear to meet the requirements of Article 52(1) EPC with respect to the available prior art, amendments are required to overcome the objections below:

3.1 Claim 1 referring to a *mobile device* seeks to define the invention by reference to an *autonomous work machine* that is not part of the claimed first entity but that is related to it through use. The intended limitations are therefore not clear from this claim, contrary to the requirements of Article 84 EPC.

3.2 Furthermore, it is not clear how the *mobile device* of claim 1 is able to *provide a machine-verified indication of user proximity within the pre-determined distance*.

However, it is clear from the description on par. [0058] that some interaction with features of the autonomous work machine (GPS 132, WiFi 130, or camera/ s 140) is essential to the definition of the invention. Since independent claim 1 does not contain such features it does not meet the requirement following from Article 84 EPC, taken in combination with Rule 43(1) and (3) EPC, that any independent claim must contain all the technical features essential to the definition of the invention.

3.3 The features in apparatus claim 2 relate to a method rather than clearly defining the apparatus (i.e. the mobile device) in terms of its technical features. The intended limitations are therefore not clear from this claim, contrary to the requirements of Article 84 EPC.

3.4 Independent claim 1 is not in the two-part form in accordance with Rule 43(1) EPC, which in the present case would be appropriate, with those features known in combination from the prior art (see par. 2 above) being placed in the preamble (Rule 43(1)(a) EPC) and the remaining features being included in the characterising part (Rule 43(1)(b) EPC).

3.5 To meet the requirements of Rule 42(1)(b) EPC, document D1 should be identified in the description and the relevant background art disclosed therein should be briefly discussed.

3.6 When filing amended claims the applicant should at the same time bring the introductory portion of the description into conformity with the amended claims (Rule 42(1)(c) EPC).

3.7 Care should be taken during revision, especially of any statements of problem or advantage, not to add subject-matter which extends beyond the content of the application as originally filed (Article 123(2) EPC).

3.8 In order to comply with the requirements of Rule 137(4) EPC, the applicant should clearly identify the amendments made, irrespective of whether they concern amendments by addition, replacement or deletion, and indicate the passages of the application as filed on which these amendments are based (see Guidelines H III, 2.1).